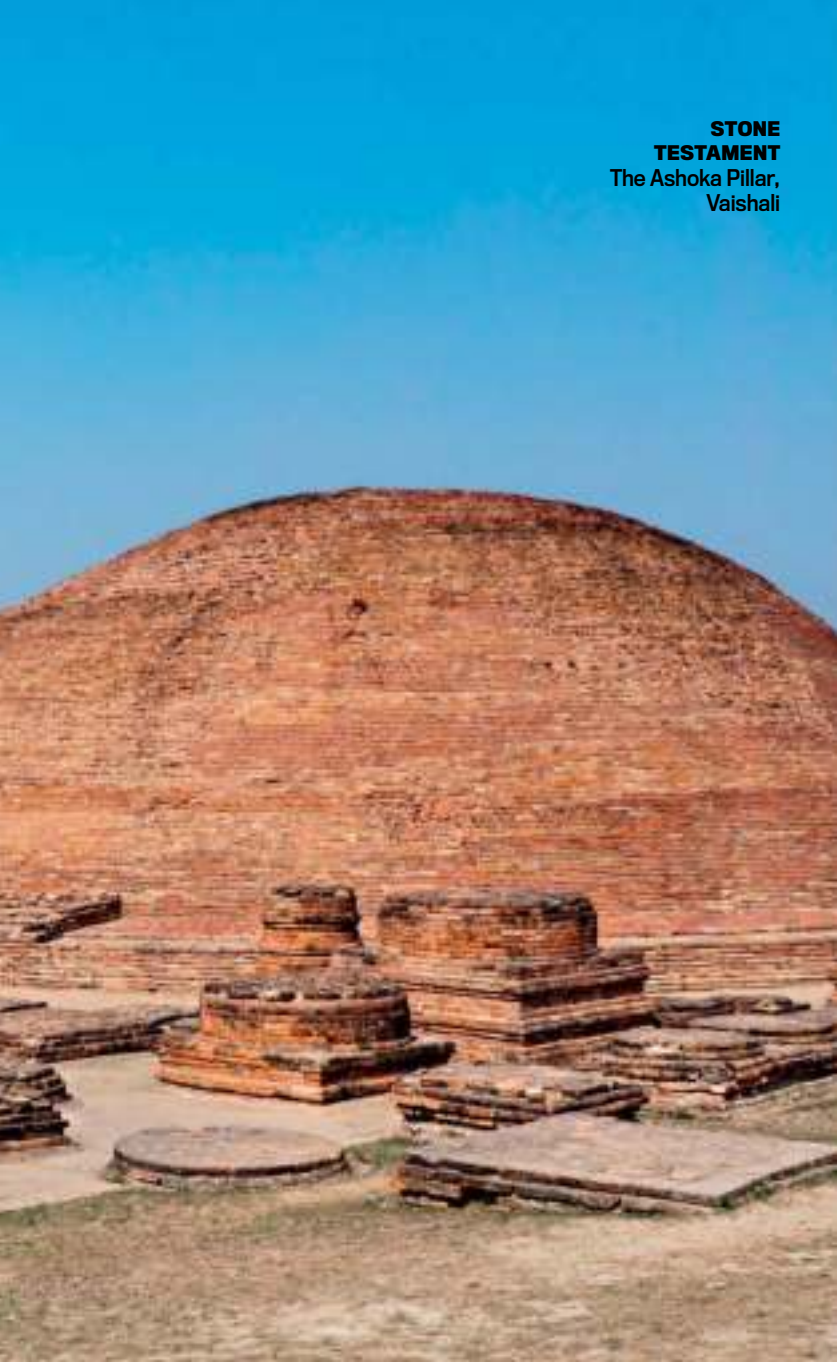


STONE TESTAMENT
The Ashoka Pillar, Vaishali



Patna: One of the world's oldest continuing capital cities, it has the serene **Buddha Smriti Park** and Karuna Stupa, and the trees that grew from two saplings planted by the Dalai Lama, one from Bodh Gaya, and the other from the Bodhi Tree in Sri Lanka's Anuradhapura. Don't miss the brilliance of the Bihar Museum, a beautifully mounted collection of artefacts ranging from prehistoric times through the various ruling dynasties, as well as the older Patna Museum.

BUDDHIST BIHAR BEYOND THE HUBS

Legend has it that **Rampurva**, on the banks of the river Anoma (now called the Harbora) in western Champaran, was where Prince Siddhartha turned to asceticism. While you may not see the huge Ashoka pillars with their edicts that were excavated at Rampurva and Lauria Nandangarh today, they are both places that are considered important in the story of Lord Buddha.

The uniquely styled **Kesariya Stupa** in eastern Champaran is possibly the world's tallest. The magnificent 104-foot-tall structure with a circumference of 1,400 feet and six terraces dates back to 200 CE.

